INSTITUTION'S INNOVATION COUNCIL
(Ministry of Education Initiative)

Institution's Innovation Council

IIC - IIT Bombay

Know Your Institute Body

What is IIC? Why does it matter? How does it work at IIT Bombay?

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Ministry of Education · AICTE · MoE's Innovation Cell (MIC)

What is This Institute Body All About?

If you're seeing "IIC" for the first time and wondering what it is - you're not alone. Some students at IIT Bombay, mostly fresher's don't know about it, and that's exactly why this document exists.

The **Institution's Innovation Council (IIC)** is a **government-mandated institute body** that exists inside every higher education institution in India. It was established in **November 2018** by the Ministry of Education through its Innovation Cell (MIC) at AICTE headquarters. Unlike student clubs, IIC is a formal part of the institute's administrative structure - it reports through Deputy Director (ART) directly to the Ministry of Education. In IIT Bombay IIC started operating in 2022.

Think of it this way: **IIC is to innovation what NAAC is to academic quality** - a nationally standardised, measurably accountable framework that ensures every college in India has a functioning innovation ecosystem.

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IIC IIT Bombay is Currently Rated 4-Star

Our rating jumped from **0.5-star to 4-star within a single year** - one of the biggest improvements among all IITs.

16,400+	50 Lakh+	1,02,000+	8
IICs Nationwide	Students & Faculty	Innovations Catalogued	Versions Since 2018

Core Mission

IIC's mission is to ensure every higher education institution has a functioning innovation ecosystem - creating awareness, helping develop ideas into prototypes, facilitating IP support, connecting students with mentors and funding, and contributing to India's Global Innovation Index.

Why Your Participation Matters

IIC is not just another body on campus - it is the **official channel through which IIT Bombay's innovation activities are reported to the Government of India**. When you participate in IIC activities, your work gets nationally documented, contributes to IIT Bombay's NIRF Innovation ranking, and connects you to government programmes worth real funding.

- **Smart India Hackathon (SIH)** - IIC coordinates participation in the world's largest hackathon. Three IIT Bombay teams won top prizes at SIH 2024 with IIC facilitating participation and mentorship.
- **Free Patent Filing via KAPILA** - Get patent filing charges reimbursed up to ₹5,600 per application. Any student or faculty member whose innovation merits a patent can benefit directly.
- **YUKTI Innovation Repository** - Register your project on a national platform with 1,02,000+ innovations. Get visibility, mentoring, and potential funding for prototypes at TRL 4+.
- **IDE Bootcamps** - Five-day immersive bootcamps on design thinking, rapid prototyping, and business models. ~10,000 participants trained in 2025.
- **Mentorship & Industry Access** - Connect with alumni entrepreneurs, industry experts, and Innovation Ambassadors through IIC's structured networks.
- **Build Your Innovation Portfolio** - Your participation is documented on a government portal. This strengthens your CV nationally - not just within IIT Bombay.
- **Startup Support Pathway** - From ideation workshops to IPR guidance to pre-incubation referrals at SINE, IIC facilitates complete pipeline from idea to market.

Every student, every department, every club matters

When your club conducts a hackathon, workshop, or innovation event, IIC can formally document and report it to the Ministry of Education. This means YOUR work contributes to IIT Bombay's national innovation profile. The more we report, the higher IIT Bombay ranks - and the more resources flow back to the institute.

How is IIC Different from E-Cell, Tech Clubs, and Student Council?

IIT Bombay already has a rich ecosystem of student-run organisations. IIC is not a replacement - it is a structurally distinct, **government-mandated institute body** that complements them.

Dimension	Student Bodies (E-Cell, Clubs)	IIC
Origin	Student-initiated; organically evolved	Government-mandated by Ministry of Education via MIC
Leadership	Student-led; faculty advisor in supporting role	Faculty-led (Current President is Deputy Director ART)
Governance	Reports to Gymkhana / Dean of Students	Reports to MIC (national body) via the IIC portal
Activity Calendar	Self-determined; flexible	Mandatory national calendar with prescribed activities per quarter
Evaluation	Internal	National star rating system (0–5 stars); quarterly review by MIC
National Linkage	Operates within institute	Direct pipeline to SIH, YUKTI, KAPILA, IDE Bootcamps, MIC programmes
Impact on Rankings	Indirect	Directly feeds into NIRF Innovation ranking
Scope	Often focused on one domain	Full spectrum: ideation → IPR → pre-incubation → startup support
Accountability	To student community and institute	To national government body with formal reporting

Think of it this way

If E-Cell is the entrepreneurship club that inspires students, IIC is the government-backed institutional framework that ensures innovation support exists at every college in India - with accountability, measurement, funding pipelines, and national coordination. At IIT Bombay, they complement each other powerfully.

What Does IIC Actually Do?

Every IIC operates on a yearly calendar divided into four quarters (Sep through Aug). Activities fall into five categories, each with specific weightage:

Pillar 1: IIC Calendar Activities (40% of Score)

Prescribed by MIC in the annual activity calendar. Includes design thinking workshops, IPR awareness sessions under KAPILA, entrepreneurship development programmes, proof-of-concept and idea pitching sessions, field visits to incubators and maker spaces, and inter-institutional innovation competitions.

Pillar 2: MIC-Driven Activities (10% of Score)

Scheduled by MIC and mandatory for all IICs. The weightage for MIC-driven activities has been reduced to 10% in the current framework. Includes the India First Leadership Talk Series, Innovation Ambassador training, IIC Regional Meets across eight zones, and national campaigns like Viksit Bharat@2047.

Pillar 3: Self-Driven Activities (30% of Score)

Independently planned by each IIC to suit their campus context. Hackathons tailored to local problems, industry mentoring sessions, startup demo days, alumni entrepreneur talks, innovation showcases, and field research expeditions. We are working on many initiatives including an AI Innovation chatbot, innovation magazine, single innovation calender for the campus, etc.

Pillar 4: R&D, Sell, and Idea Cafe (10% of Score)

Dedicated 10% weightage for R&D initiatives, Sell (commercialisation activities), and Idea Cafe - structured platforms for research outputs, pitching and selling innovations, and open idea-sharing sessions fostering cross-disciplinary collaboration.

Pillar 5: Celebration Day Activities (10% of Score)

Observing nationally significant days: National Startup Day (Jan 16), World IP Day (Apr 26), National Science Day (Feb 28), and National Youth Day (Jan 12).

IIC 8.0 Quarterly Themes (2025–26)

Q1: Awareness & Idea Generation | Q2: Skill Development | Q3: Prototyping & Business Model Development | Q4: Startup Ecosystem & Scale-up. Activities graded Level 1 (awareness) to Level 4 (hackathons 18+ hours).

How IIC Maps Events at IIT Bombay

For Calendar and Self-Driven Activities, IIC IIT Bombay does not operate in isolation. We **collaborate with different student clubs, student bodies, and institute bodies** to map their events with our IIC calendar and report them to the Ministry of Education. When a student body conducts a hackathon, workshop, or innovation event, IIC works with them to ensure it gets formally documented and reported at the national level.

This collaborative model ensures that innovation happening across IIT Bombay - whether from E-Cell, a technical club, a department, or any other body - is captured, credited, and made visible on the national stage.

> *"Because IIC is an institute body, everything that IIC reports to the Ministry of Education represents IIT Bombay. Therefore, all student clubs, student bodies, and institute bodies should make sure that all of their events are reported to the Ministry of Education through IIC. All bodies should follow the guidelines given by the Ministry of Education and help IIC in reporting the same."*
>
> - **Professor Milind Atrey**
>
> *Deputy Director (Academic & Research Transition), IIT Bombay - Stated at the IIC Quarterly Meeting, February 2026*

This directive makes it clear: **IIC is the official channel through which IIT Bombay's innovation activities reach the Ministry of Education.** Every student body and institute body has a role to play.

How Can You Get Involved?

Whether you're a student, a club head, or a faculty member, there are concrete ways to engage with IIC:

- **If you're a student:** Participate in IIC-coordinated events like SIH, Hackathons, YUKTI submissions, and Celebration Day activities. Register your innovations on the YUKTI portal. File patents through KAPILA.
- **If you run a student club or body:** Coordinate with IIC to map your innovation-related events to the IIC calendar. This gets your events nationally documented and contributes to IIT Bombay's NIRF Innovation ranking. The upper management of IIT Bombay looks at which body is contributing the most to IIC in reporting innovation activities and gets rewarded. We can also help you with room bookings, publicity, getting access to experts, etc.
- **If you're a faculty member:** Become a certified Innovation Ambassador through MIC's training programme. Use KAPILA for patent filing support. Report your innovation activities through IIC.
- **If you're a department or centre:** Ensure your workshops, hackathons, and innovation activities are reported through IIC to the Ministry of Education. Every event counts.

Join the IIC IITB WhatsApp Community

Stay updated on IIC activities, national programmes, hackathon announcements, and innovation opportunities at IIT Bombay.

https://chat.whatsapp.com/GUXd3Fk4SLb4jreUJO6Q43

IIC at IIT Bombay

IIT Bombay possesses one of India's most mature innovation ecosystems. IIC integrates as a government compliance and national coordination layer on the existing innovation ecosystem:

Entity	What It Does
SINE	Technology business incubator; 200+ startups incubated
E-Cell	Student-run; E-Summit (30,000+ footfall), Eureka!, startup mentoring
DSSE	Academic unit; 20+ courses, minor degree, pre-incubation programmes
IRCC	Industry-sponsored research, IP, and technology transfer
BETIC	Healthcare innovation and medical device development
Research Park	Industry co-location and collaborative research facility

IIC's Specific Role at IIT Bombay

- Coordinating Smart India Hackathon participation - three teams won top prizes at SIH 2024
- Connecting students to KAPILA for patent filing support and IP awareness
- Formal channel to register innovations on the YUKTI platform
- Contributing to IIT Bombay's NIRF Innovation ranking through documented activities
- Collaborating with student clubs and institute bodies to map events with the IIC calendar
- Co-organising events like Greenovate 2025 (sustainability innovation showcase)
- Filing quarterly reports to MIC ensuring national visibility

How IIC Performance is Measured

The Star Rating System: 0–5 stars in half-star increments, max 100 points:

Component	Weightage	Details
Activity Score	80%	All five activity pillars across four quarters. Each quarter = max 25 marks (1 star).
Reward Score	20%	Broader MIC initiatives, exceptional achievements, outputs beyond calendar.
Fifth Star	Discretionary	Reserved for MIC for truly exceptional achievements.

Star ratings directly feed into the NIRF Innovation ranking. IIC IIT Bombay's jump from **2.5-star to 4-star within a single year** demonstrates the impact of systematic, collaborative reporting of innovation activities.

Why IIC Matters: The Bigger Picture

India's Global Innovation Index: 86th (2015) → 38th (2024), targeting Top 20. IIC is central - innovation ecosystems at 16,400+ institutions simultaneously multiplies the country's capacity by orders of magnitude.

The Complete Innovation Pipeline

- **Awareness** - Celebration Day activities and orientation sessions
- **Ideation** - Design thinking workshops and idea competitions
- **Skill Building** - IDE Bootcamps and Innovation Ambassador sessions
- **Prototyping** - Hackathons (especially SIH) for working solutions
- **IP Protection** - KAPILA for patent filing support
- **Validation** - YUKTI catalogues innovations with expert evaluation
- **Incubation** - Connection to SINE at IIT Bombay
- **Startup Creation** - Full pipeline from ideation to market-ready product

What's Coming Next

- **City Innovation Clusters** - Scaling across 250 cities with institutions, industries, and investors.
- **Indovation Centres** - 12–13 regional hubs backed by $10M annual investment with Wadhwani Foundation.
- **Academic Credits for Innovation** - AICTE now gives academic credits for startup projects, even at ideation stage.
- **Expansion Beyond Technical Institutions** - Arts, commerce, science colleges joining - potentially tripling the network.

Key Resources & Links

Resource	URL / Contact	Purpose
IIC Official Portal	iic.mic.gov.in	Activity reporting, tracking, registration
MoE Innovation Cell	mic.gov.in	National coordination, policy updates
Smart India Hackathon	sih.gov.in	Hackathon registration and submissions
YUKTI Portal	yukti.mic.gov.in	Innovation registration, funding opportunities
KAPILA Portal	kapila.mic.gov.in	Patent filing support and IP literacy
IDE Bootcamp	bootcamp.mic.gov.in	Bootcamp registration and resources
SINE (IIT Bombay)	sineiitb.org	Incubation support for innovators
E-Cell (IIT Bombay)	ecell.in	Student entrepreneurship activities
DSSE (IIT Bombay)	dsse.iitb.ac.in	Academic programmes in entrepreneurship

While IIC's central stakeholder is university students, IIC is not a student club. It is a nationally standardised, government-mandated framework. Its strength: **scale** (16,400+ councils, 50 lakh+ people), **structure** (star ratings, quarterly accountability), and **connectivity** (direct pipeline to national programmes with real funding).

For IIT Bombay, IIC is the formal bridge between campus innovation and national policy - the channel for SIH coordination, YUKTI cataloguing, patent reimbursement, and institutional performance measurement against every college in India.

Join the IIC IITB WhatsApp Community Today

https://chat.whatsapp.com/GUXd3Fk4SLb4jreUJO6Q43